



Genre: RTS
Studio: Firaxis
Publishers: 2K Games
Platforms: PC

THE SKOAR! CIVILIZATION V

THE SKOAR

7

Learn to be kind

Sid Meier has a long-standing and dedicated following of gamers who know exactly what to expect from his games. In this respect, the fifth installment in the long enduring Civilization series is true to its roots. The fundamental game-play rules remains unchanged and those familiar with the series will need little introduction to this game. For the uninitiated, let's take a look at the game's basic game-play mechanics.

Great powers

The single-player mode of Civilization V starts with the player choosing a civilization from an impressive list of 18. Each Civilization is represented by a leader, who also doubles up at the player's avatar in the game. Also, each of these civilizations has unique characteristics that give them bonuses or access to exclusive structures

and units. The game allows the player to customize their experience with options like difficulty level, number of opposing players, size and type of world map, and victory conditions. This makes Civilization V one of the most scalable strategy games in terms of challenge and difficulty.

After the game variables are selected, the system generates a map with randomly dispersed resources across the map. Establish your civilization's capital city. From this point on, the main objective of the game is to expand the civilization's influence either through expansion, war, technology, culture or diplomacy, and ultimately achieve any one of the victory objectives.

Paths to domination

What sets Civilization V apart from the rest is the multi-

tude of options available to achieve this. Conquest is the most straight forward way of dominating a map, but there are other, more interesting ways of achieving the final objective. The player can focus on technological advances through research in an endeavor to win the game by being the first to build a spaceship. Alternatively, players can achieve cultural victory by adopting five different social policies and then undertaking the 'utopian project'.

Lastly, one can also reach the end game by pursuing a diplomatic victory where relationship with city-states takes the center stage. City-states are other AI controlled player's on the board that have strategic importance, but are not in contention for power like other civilizations. Having strong diplomatic ties with these states becomes

indispensible during the diplomatic victory end-game.

Great value

Completing a single play-through of Civilization V runs into tens of hours—now, multiply that with over 18 different civilizations and various paths to victory, and you have countless hours of game-play. Beyond that the game supports multiplayer over internet and also has LAN support. In addition, a modding toolkit is available as a separate and free download.

Civilization V requires a lot of system RAM, especially towards the end-game. Also during this phase of the game, when the board is completely occupied by various civilizations, waiting between turns is relatively lengthy. These are the only two things that go against what is otherwise a pretty solid game. 